

Christian Hospital Bissamcuttack

Past, present and future.....

Setting:

Bissamcuttack is a small town in the hill district of Rayagada, Odisha – part of the vulnerable KBK region. The area is beautiful, with forested hills & winding mountain streams. The people of this region are mostly from the Adivasi community; 62% belong to the Kondh tribe & 18% to the Dalit community. The needs in this area are enormous.

The health status is fragile and weak, with endemic malaria and other infectious diseases on one hand and rising non-communicable diseases on the other, accentuating the vulnerability of all who live in the area. The Block reported a negative Growth Rate of -8% in the decade 1981—1991. The District Literacy Rate rose from Census 2001 to 2011 from 36% to 51%, with female literacy rising from 26% to 40%, yet far below the national and state averages. In pursuit of a healthy and vibrant India, with the vision of Health for all, Bissamcuttack has long way to go.

History:

It all began in 1954, when a lady doctor from Denmark, Dr Elisabeth Madsen, heard of the huge health needs in this region, & came out to begin work on the verandah of the church. She trained local people to take on the various tasks needed in a small hospital, all the while going out to nodal villages in the region, to ensure access to care. She led the fledgling institution for the first 22 years, with the support of the Danish Missionary Society.



In 1975, with age creeping up and funding coming down, Dr. Madsen decided to search for new leadership that could run this hospital independently, so that it would stand on its own feet, without external support. And thus it was that Dr. Virendra Kumar Henry, a surgeon from Chattishgarh, & his wife, Nancy Henry, an American Nurse, came to CHB. Within the next four years, they and their team of staff were able to reach the point of financial sustainability for running expenses. Then came the time of vision and Building. The Henries led CHB in a blur of growth and expansion over the second 22 years, 1976-1998. In 1978, CHB started a School of Nursing, recognised by the Indian Nursing, Recognised by the Indian Nursing Council, to train ANM's for Odisha.

In 1976, a Community Health Project was started by Dr Madsen, covering 90 adivasi villages in 3 Gram Panchyats. In 1980, a second Community Health Project was started by the Nursing Department in Dakuluguda village. In 1986, an English Medium School was opened on campus, both to help attract and retain professional staff and to provide the crucial catalytic influence of quality education for a region that needs strategic inputs. In 1998, Dr Madsen returned to Denmark, where she died in 1991. In 1994, the Community Health work of the hospital was revamped & refocused, under the operational name of MITRA (Madsen's Institute for Tribal and Rural Advancement). In 1996, the General Nursing Programme and in 2018 BSc Nursing programme were added to the School of Nursing.



In 1998, Dr Henry handed over charge to Dr Padmashree Sahu. The same year, the Mitra Residential School, Kachapaju was opened – a residential, primary school for the children of 16 hill- tribe villages, jointly managed by CHB & the Malkondh Anchalika Sangho, a people's organisation.

After Dr Padmashree Sahu, the following leaders took the responsibilities.

- Dr Hemaprabha Mahanty : 2011 – 2021
- Dr John Cherian Oommen : 2021 – 2022
- Dr Sunil Chander Jiwanmall : 2022 onwards

The CHB Today

Our Mission and Vision

We are a faith based community, called to

- To Share the pain of people
- To Respond and serve with love
- To Be the change we want to see

Our focus on

- Health Care
 - of High quality and low cost
 - especially focus on poor and marginalised
- Training in Health
 - Situational excellence and social relevance
- Education for children
 - That is Appropriate and excellent
 - That transforms and empowers



Our Activities and work focussing on 3 fold service output

- Patient Care
 - Out-Patient Service-Medicine, Surgical, Obstetrics, Paediatric, Eye, Dental, Laboratory, X-Ray, Pharmacy, Ultrasound, Emergency Care Unit
 - In Patient Service-200 bedded secondary hospital + Empanelled with BSKY (Health Insurance Programme of Odisha Government)





- Community Health Service – In 55 Adivasi villages, 13,000 population, Primary Health Care, Community Education, Youth Initiatives



• Training in Health

- CHB College of Nursing with hostel facility : GNM 3 years course-per year 20 students, BScN Nursing 4 years course-per year 20 students



- Mitra Training and Resource Unit



• Education

- New Life English Medium School - from class LKG to class 10 (600 students)



- Mitra Residential School, Kachapaju - from class 1 to 5 (155 students)
- Mitra Community Education Programme



Key Health Indicators

No	Indicators	2022-2023
1	Out Patient	72,855
2	Indoor Patient	63799
3	Deliveries	2735
4	Surgeries	4958

Our Future Initiatives by 2026

1. Health Care Service Area

- ICU Setup
- Up gradation of Diagnostic Area
 - CT Scan
 - Endoscopy

2. Education Area

- New Infrastructure for NLEM School
- Up gradation of NLEM school into Higher Secondary School



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Christian Hospital Bissamcuttack